Markdown, Github & Copilot: A new way to journal (business) life

Dennie Declercq // 2025

About Me: Dennie Declercq

- Dennie Declercq
- President & IT-Coach DDSoft
- Microsoft MVP
- Mr. #DreamingIsBelieving
- @DennieDeclercq

Content

Introduction: The Quest of 2024

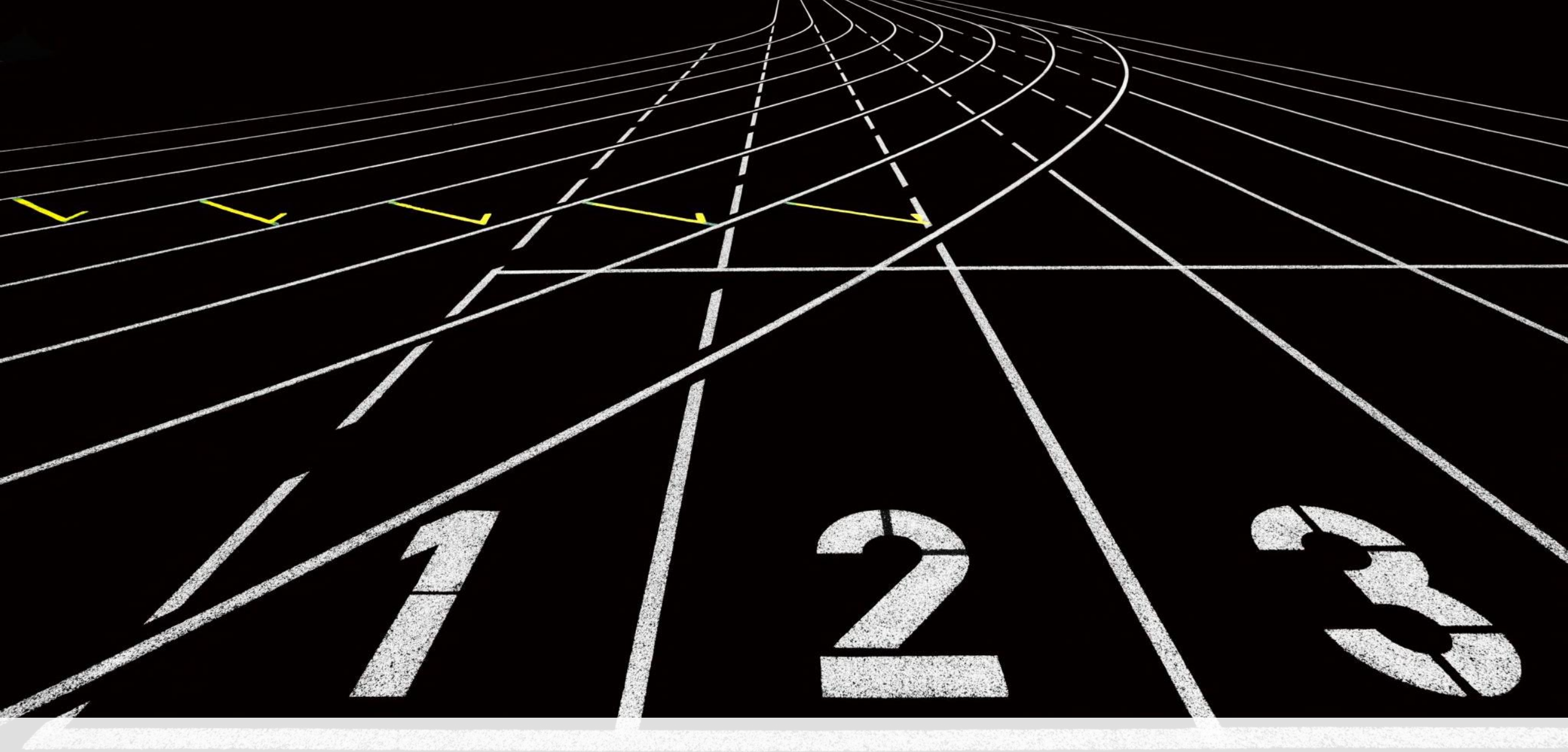
A private Github setup

Coding text in Markdown

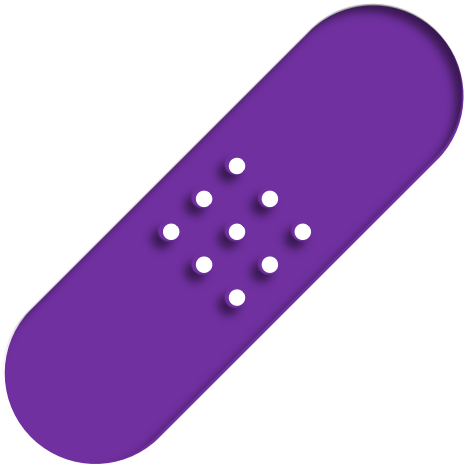
Copilot to the rescue

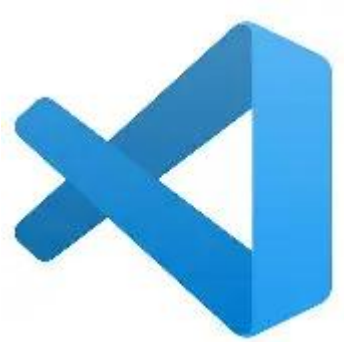
My visual Mermaid

Outro



The Quest of 2024



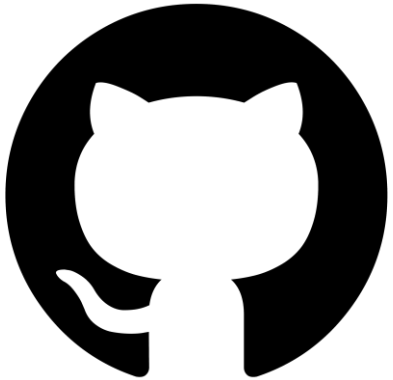


1 & 1 = 3 (Binary 011 == 3)

- AI assisted journaling in Markdown worked to manage my health follow up.
- I loved to do this. It gave me joy next to the problems I experienced.
- I still have a bad handwriting.
- I always had issues with keeping up my business notes.
- I always had issues with personal note taking (leads to forgetting a lot).
- I always hated to use different tool stack (the right tool for the right job is not easy) Blame Autism!
- So, I started journalling everything on the AI assisted markdown way!

A private Github setup

Where do developers live?



On Github

In a Code Editor or IDE

Private Github for everyone

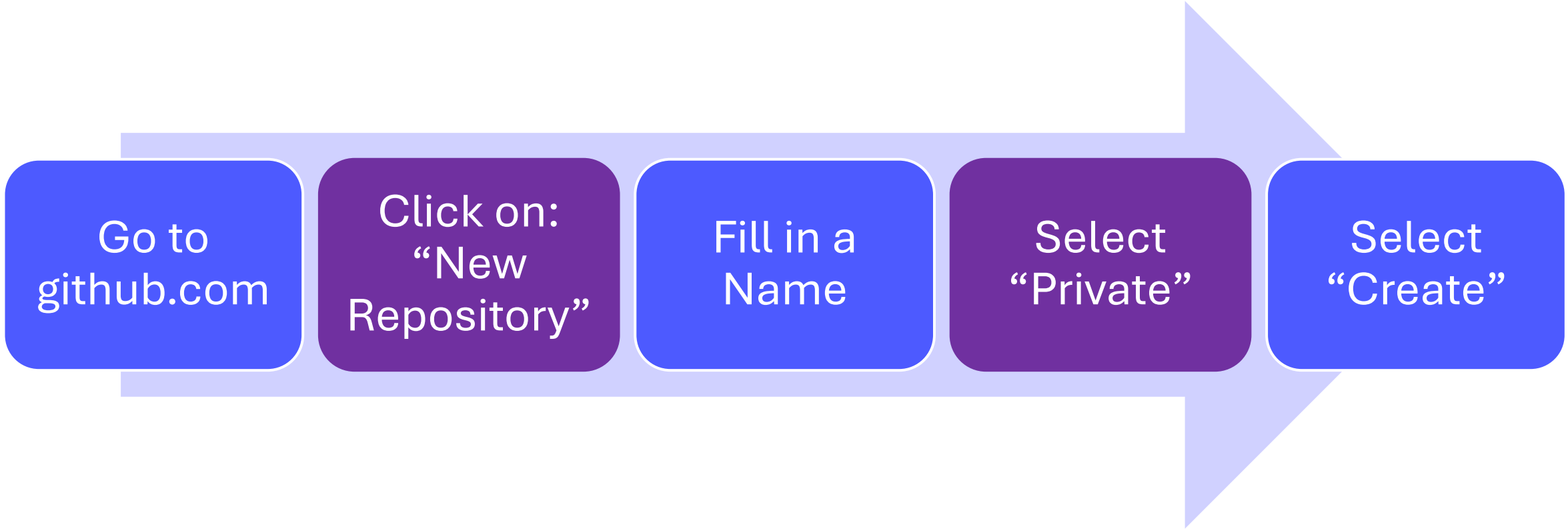
2008
- Github Launched for collaborating OSS
- Has Paid Features (ex: Private Repos)

2018
- Microsoft Acquires Github

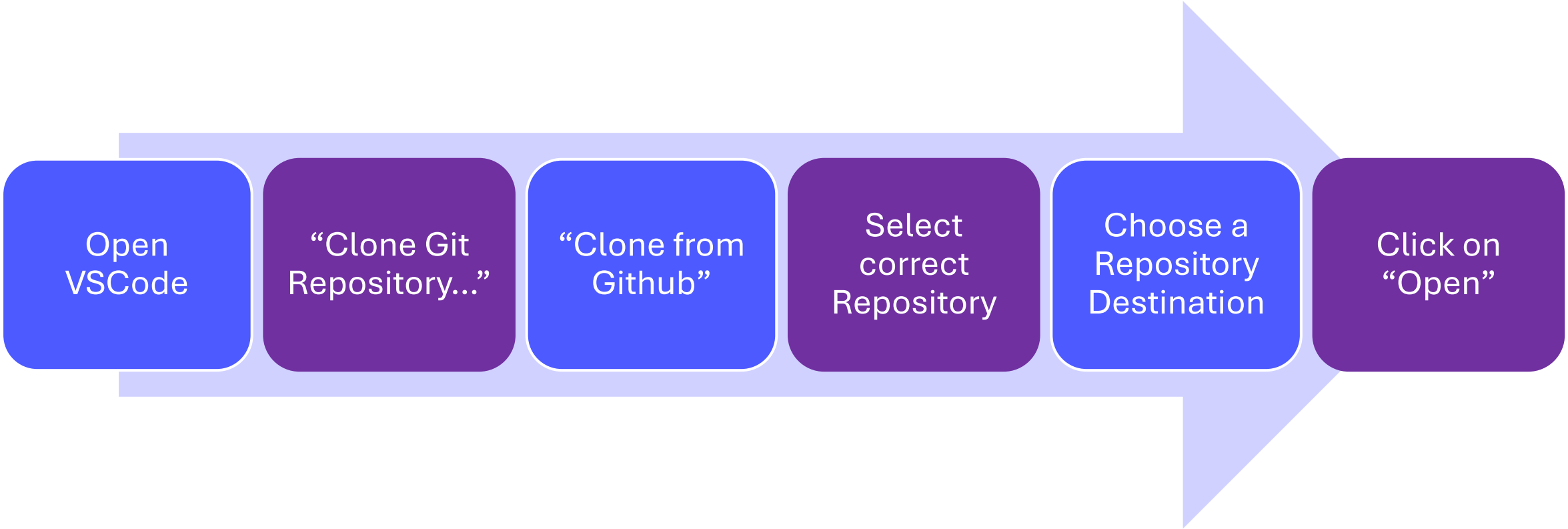
2019
- Limited Private Repos are free

2020
- Private repo’ s are official free

Making a private repo



Using the repo in VSCode

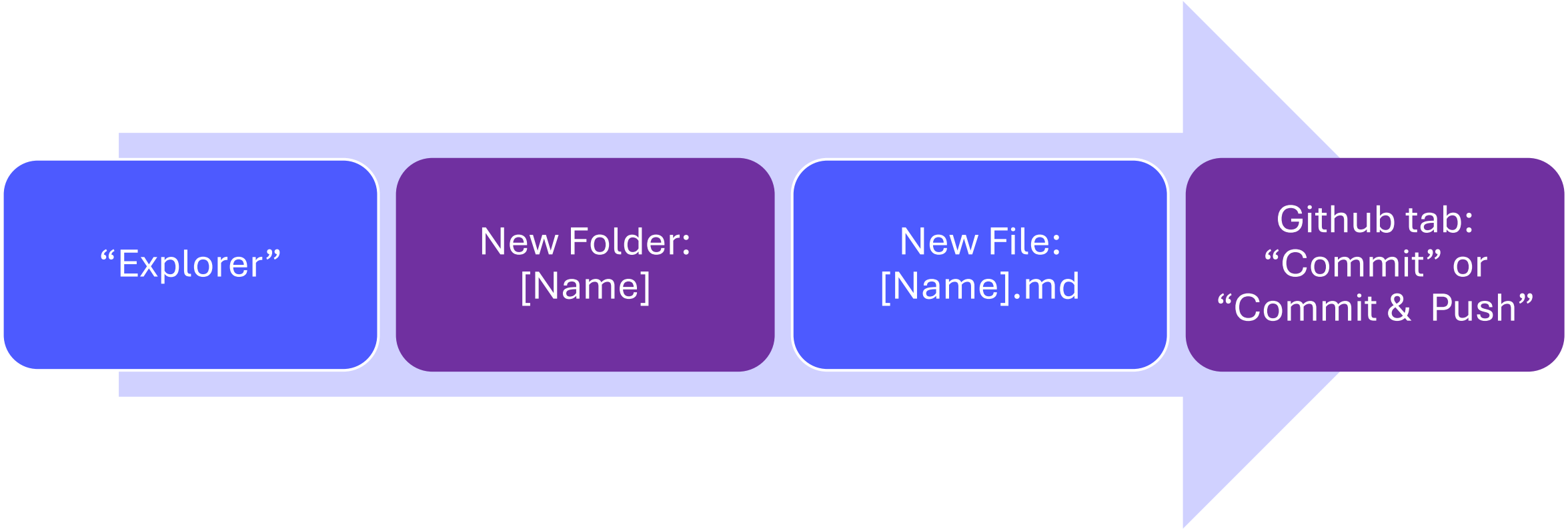


Useful VSCode extensions

Code Spell Checker

Code Spell Checker – [Language]

Creating a folder structure



Github Mobile App

There’s an App for that!

DEMO

Private Github setup

Coding text in Markdown

Markdown is text in code

- Text documents
- The style and format of the text is done by coding
- Nicely rendered in Github
- VS Code has a previewer

Useful VSCode extensions

Code Spell Checker

Code Spell Checker – [Language]

Markdown Notebook

Formatting Text

```
# Heading – H1
## H2
Text
**Bold**
__Bold__
*Italic*
_Italic_
***Bold italic***
___Bold italic***
```

Heading – H1

H2

Text

Bold

Bold

Italic

Italic

Bold italic

Bold italic

Making Lists

This is a simple list:

- Item 1
- Item 2

Multi level list (DDSoft):

* Dennie Declercq
  * President
  * Trainer
* Marlies
  * Administration

This is a simple list:

- Item 1
- Item 2

Multi level list (DDSoft):

- Dennie Declercq
  - President
  - Trainer
- Marlies
  - Administration

Making a table

```
| Name | Function | Needs |
|---------|------------|----------|
| Dennie | President | Experiences |
| Rob | Developer | Enough rest |
|---------|------------|----------|
```

Name	Function	Needs
Dennie	President	Experiences
Rob	Developer	Enough rest

Displaying code

```csharp
using System;


public class Program
{
   public static void Main()
   {
      Console.WriteLine("Hello, World!");
   }


}
```

```
using System;

  public class Program
{
    public static void Main()
    {
        Console.WriteLine("Hello, World!");
    }
}
```

Display Images

```
![This is me](../img/portraitskcdc0030.jpg)

![This is my proud](https://ware.ddsoft.be/wp-content/uploads/2022/11/ddware-logo-300.png)
```

Links

[Go to readme](../README.md)

[Go to KCDC](https://kcdc.info)

README.md

Go to KCDC

Others

> this is an important quote!

>

>> #DreamingIsBelieving

This is a line.

****

This is an important quote!

#DreamingIsBelieving

This is a Line.

Creating a navigation system

EXPLORER

DDKCDC25
- Day1
  - Day1.md U
- Day2
  - Day2.md U
- README.md U

Welcome | README.md U | Day1.md U | Day2.md U

README.md > # KCDC > ## Day 2

```md
# KCDC

## [Day 1](Day1/Day1.md)

## [Day 2](Day2/Day2.md)
```

DEMO

Introducing Markdown Format

Copilot to the rescue

Useful VSCode extensions

GitHub Copilot

GitHub Copilot Chat

Ghostwriting

Ghostwriting - example

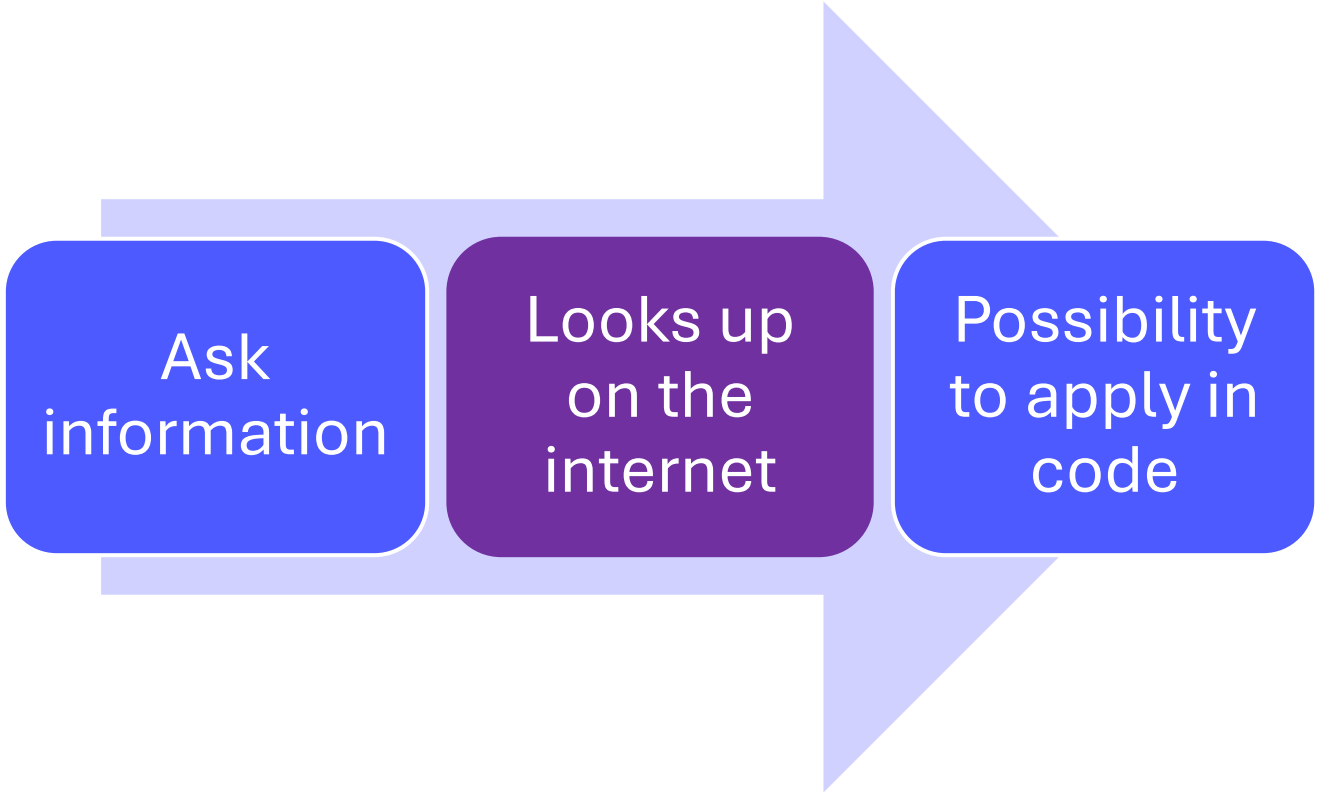
```
# Day 1

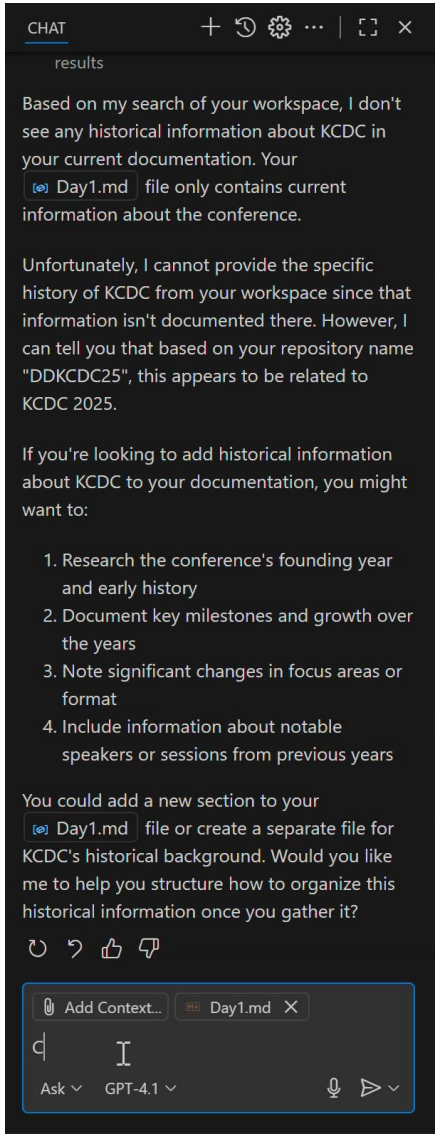
## Introduction

KCDC is a conference that brings together developers, designers, and tech
enthusiasts to share knowledge and network. This year, the focus is on the latest
trends in software development, including AI, cloud computing, and web
technologies.

It is located in Kansas City, Missouri, and features a variety of sessions,
workshops, and keynote speeches from industry leaders.
```

Copilot chat (Ask)



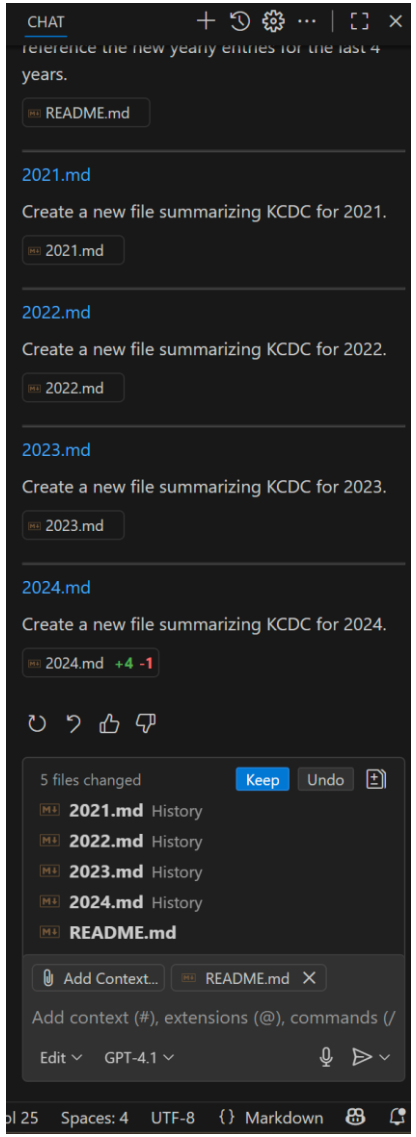


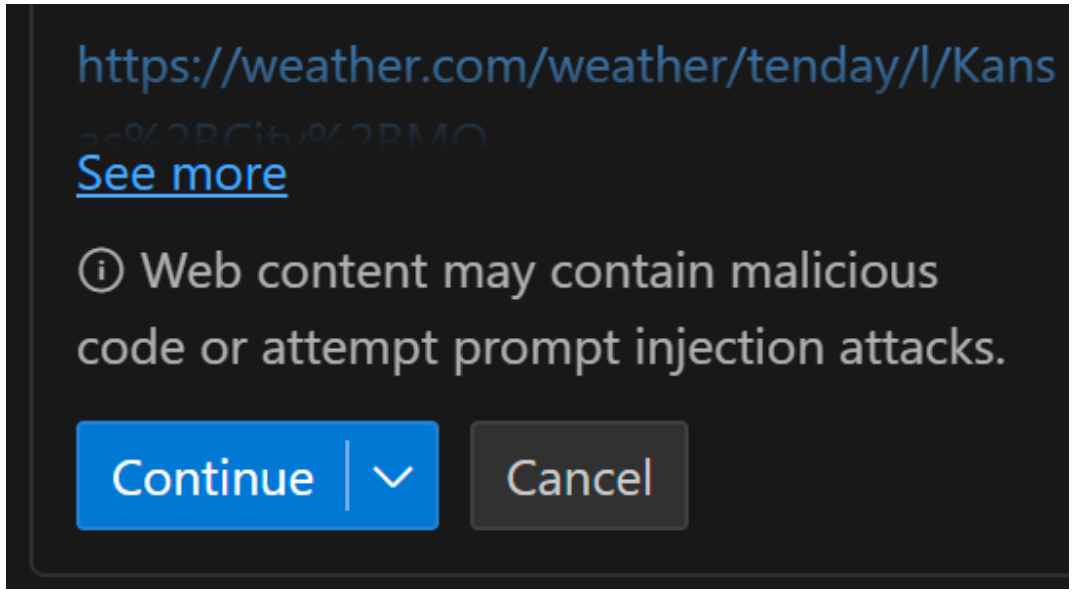
Copilot Edit mode (Edit)

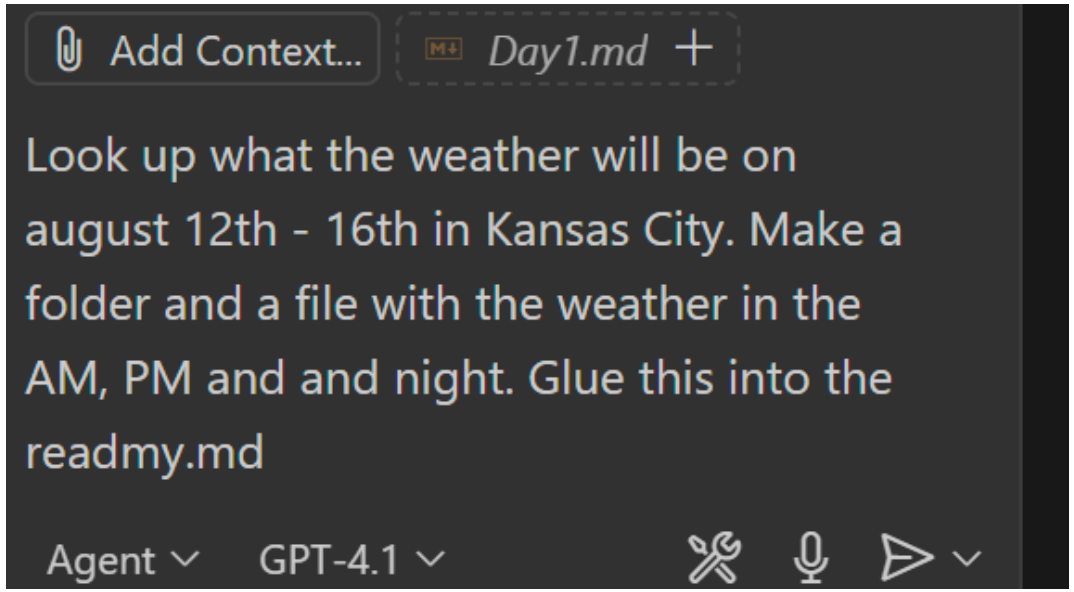
Works on (multiple code files)

Creates files

Creates Content for the files







Copilot Agent Mode

- Interaction with Other Agents
- MCP
- Agent 2 Agent Model

Generating tables

1.

Add Context... | Day1.md:11-13

put the sessions here in a table

Edit | GPT-4.1

2.

```
AI Killed your privacy tools - Ben Dechrai - Security
The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence - Richard Campbell - AI
How to enhance your own AI services using Semantic Kernel - Hakan Silfvernagel - AI
| Session Title                                                |
Speaker                | Track      |
|-------------------------------------------------------------|
------------------------|-----------|
| AI Killed your privacy tools                                | Ben
Dechrai                | Security   |
| The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence           | Richard
Campbell               | AI         |
| How to enhance your own AI services using Semantic Kernel | Hakan
Silfvernagel           | AI         |
```

3.

sessions

Session Title	Speaker	Track
AI Killed your privacy tools	Ben Dechrai	Security
The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence	Richard Campbell	AI
How to enhance your own AI services using Se	Hakan	

```
## Using GPT Visual Capabilities to Solve

### Speaker: Jennifer Marsman

### Category: AI

### Notes
* **Using pictures and diagrams in GPT pr
  * Using diagrams to explain concepts;
  * Using pictures to ask what's in the p
  * Using an electronic circuit diagram t
  * "What is this?";
* **Asking for clarification**:
  * "Is it likely to be a cat or a dog?";
  * "This is a dog, what is the breed?";
  * "This is a pet, which pet is it?";

### DDIdeas

### Links
```

1 file changed

README.md

Add Context... NDCLondon.md KCDC.md

Create a structure for KCDC, Use the wa NDCLondon works. I want to add following talks: AI killed your privacy to - Ben Dechrai - Security; The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence - Richa Campbell - AI; How to enhance your ow AI services using Semantic Kernel - Hak Silfvernagel - AI.

Edit GPT-4.1

```
- [Stats](Stats.md/KCDC.md)
- [Mermaids](Mermaids.md/KCDC.md)
- [Back](../README.md)

## AI killed your privacy tools

### Speaker: Ben Dechrai

### Category: Security

### Notes

### DDIdeas

### Links

## The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence

### Speaker: Richard Campbell

### Category: AI

### Notes

### DDIdeas

### Links

## How to enhance your own AI services using Semantic Kernel

### Speaker: Hakan Silfvernagel

### Category: AI

### Notes
```

Keep Undo 1 of 1

KCDC 2025

- Stats
- Mermaids
- Back

AI killed your privacy tools

Speaker: Ben Dechrai

Category: Security

Notes

DDIdeas

Links

The Perils and Promise of Artificial Intelligence

Speaker: Richard Campbell

Category: AI

Notes

DDIdeas

Links

1. 2. 3. 4.

Generating summarization

Generating Translations

1.

Add Context...

ChatGPTAppDeleteChat.md

translate ChatGPTAppWissen to here

Edit GPT-4.1

2.

```
# Delete Chat in ChatGPT App

To delete a chat in the ChatGPT app, follow these steps:

1. Open the ChatGPT app.
2. Navigate to the chat you want to delete.
3. Tap and hold the chat.
4. Select "Delete" from the menu.
5. Confirm the deletion.

> **Note:** Deleted chats cannot be recovered.
```

3.

Delete Chat in ChatGPT App

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DEMO

Copilot to the rescue

My visual Mermaid

What is Mermaid?

Code-based diagrams generated directly from text

A code-based – diagramming and charting tool

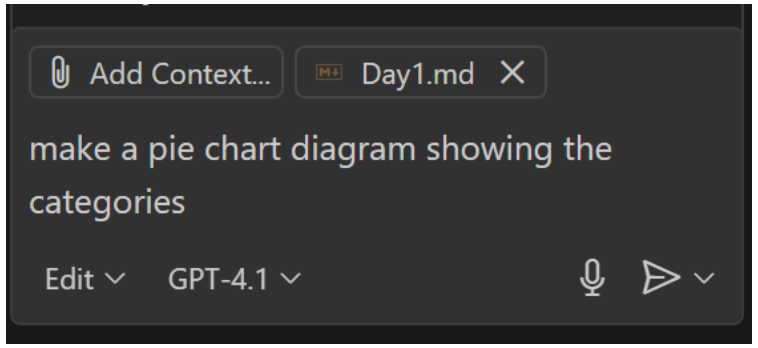
Copilot can generate Mermaid code

VSCode Extensions

Markdown Preview Mermaid Support

Generating Mermaid Diagrams

1.

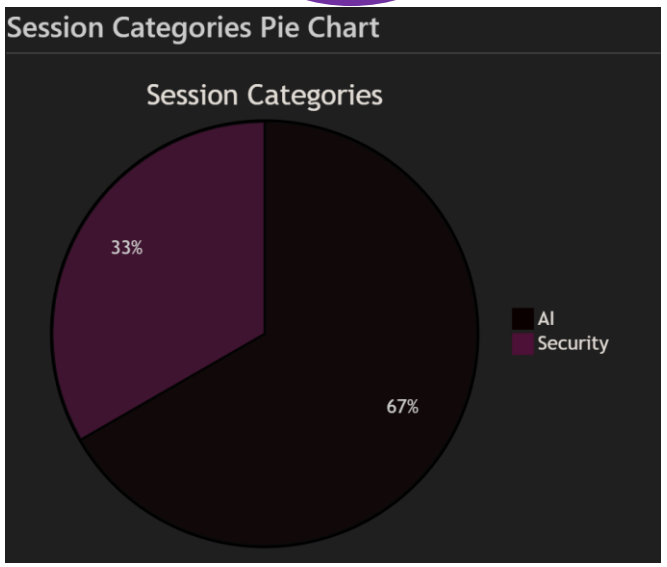


2.

```
## Session Categories Pie Chart

```mermaid
pie
    title Session Categories
    "AI" : 2
    "Security" : 1
```
```

3.



DEMO

Generation Mermaid Diagrams

Recap

- How to use Private Repo's in Github
- How Markdown is code
- How to use Copilot to journal in Markdown
- How to enhance your journal via Mermaid Diagrams
- How to create your Journal repo using all that jazz

Thanks // Q&A

- Dennie Declercq
- dennie@ddsoft.be

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outsystems

ORACLE Database

NAIC NATIONAL ASSOCIATION OF INSURANCE COMMISSIONERS

NIPR NATIONAL INSURANCE PRODUCER REGISTRY

Nx

LocalStack

DON'T PAN!C LABS

Couchbase

descope

Chainguard

ascend LEARNING

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